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Preparation of Blood Smear

The examination of peripheral dry blood smear is a very important laboratory test as it is possible to

- Estimate approximately the number of cellular components
- Study the morphology of these components
- Observe the presence of blood parasites
- Study the response of the body to various diseases

The methodology for the preparation of blood smear is as follows (Figure12.11)

1. Place a drop of blood on a clean glass slide about 1cm from one end
2. Using another glass slide placed at an angle of about 45° to the previous slide.
3. Spread the drop of blood quickly in one stroke as a thin film
4. Stain the film using Leishman's stain
5. Allow the slide to dry and wash the excess stain
6. Observe the slide under a light microscope (Figure12.12).

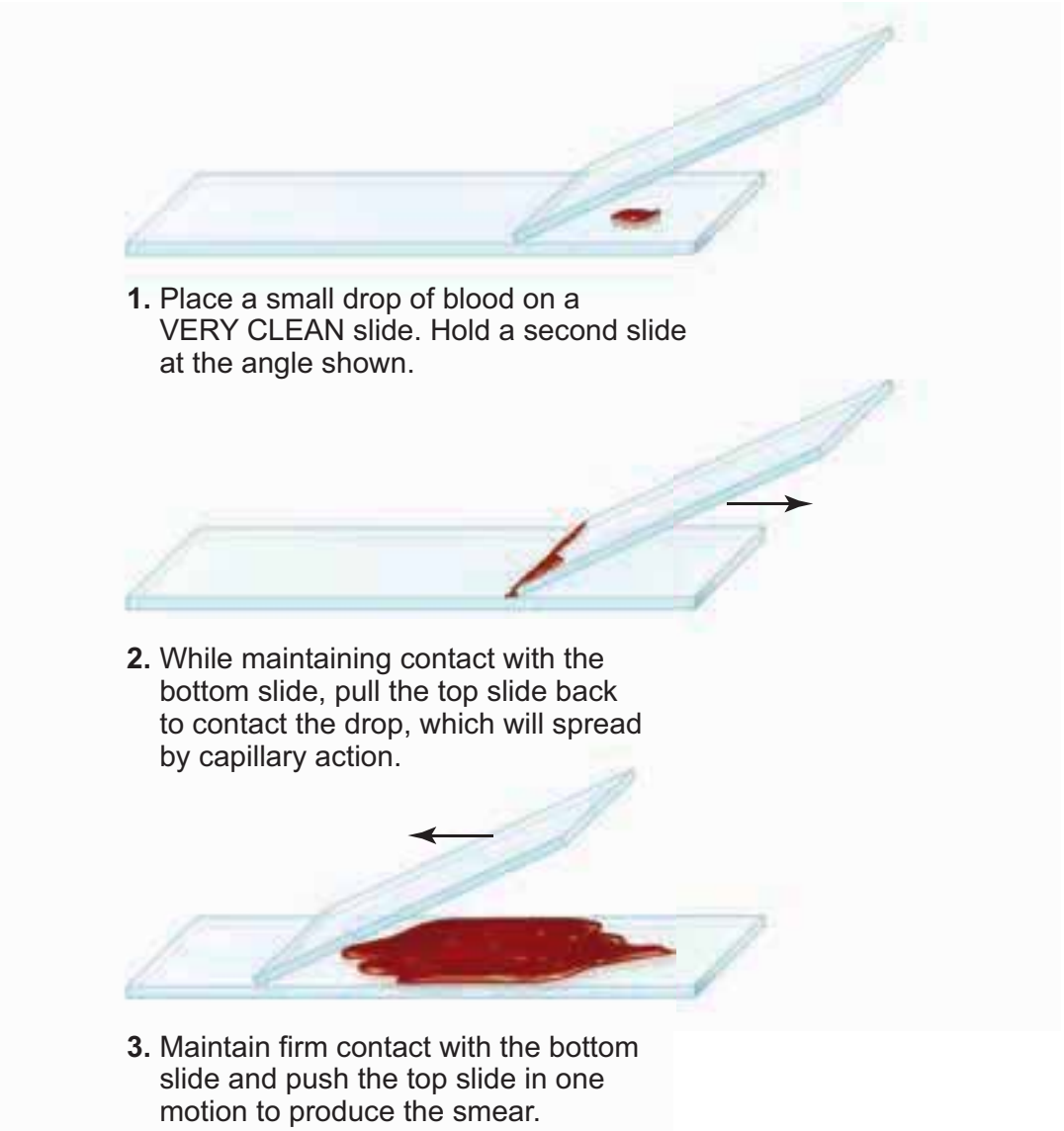

Figure12.11 Peripheral blood smear prepation